a FlexLifeFi K-12 program

What to Watch For at Home

One good question per quarter - no quizzing, no pressure.

Grade 11 year theme — Leadership, Sales, and Execution.
The 9-12 band is built for the adults who will scrutinize: parents, teachers, administrators.

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GRADE 11 · PARENT GUIDE

What to Watch For at Home

Leading three people, listening to one customer, executing six weeks.

11

A short, practical guide for the adult who lives with a Grade 11 Cash to Company student.

WITH CASH - 9-12 VOICE

"Profit is an opinion. Cash is a fact."

What this year is

> **“You can pick what kind of business you build. It's a choice.”**
>
> - CASH, GRADE 11

This year, your student is learning the moves of running a venture or running a team — leading three people for four weeks, running real sales conversations, building a 12-month cash flow forecast, and executing a 6-week sprint that ends with an investor-style pitch to a panel of adults.

Junior year is the year reality moves in. Many Grade 11 students are working real jobs and weighing college decisions with cost implications. Cash to Company at Grade 11 leans into that without exploiting it. The point is not to make money this year. The point is the muscles: leading, listening, doing the math, telling the truth, and finding out what you got wrong before it is expensive to be wrong.

By June your student will have led a 3-person team, recorded themselves selling, built a spreadsheet that names the month their venture is most likely to run out of cash, run a 6-week sprint with five named experiments, and pitched the result to a real panel.

What your student is bringing home

- A **Capstone Journal** — the messy notebook where they sketch, plan, and reflect.
- A **Student Activity Book** — structured worksheets with charter sections, sales scripts, cash flow tables, and reflection prompts.
- Occasional **Cash videos** (2:30–3:00 each). The Grade 11 voice is older — multi-sentence arguments, no hype.
- A **team charter** — they're working with two other students all year on one venture.

- A **sales recording** — at some point they will record themselves selling and watch it back.

They'll talk about their "tight month," "discovery questions," "5-experiment backlog," and "pitch deck." If those terms feel new, that's fine. Your student will explain.

What you don't need to do

- **You don't need to know any of this.** A parent with no business background can fully support this curriculum.
- **You don't need to fund anything.** The 6-week sprint can be done entirely on $0 with widely-available tools and word-of-mouth distribution.
- **You don't need to share your finances.** Curriculum-wide policy: no student is asked to share family financial details. There is no homework that requires it.

What you can do (if you want)

> **"Revenue is loud. Contribution margin is true. Compute one number this week."**
>
> - CASH, GRADE 11

These are optional. None are required.

1. Ask one good question per quarter

- **September–October (Unit 1):** "What's the hardest part of leading three people who are also your peers?"
- **November–January (Unit 2):** "What's the difference between a great sales conversation and a manipulative one? Where do you draw the line?"
- **February–April (Unit 3):** "Which month is your venture's tight month? What's your fix?"
- **May–June (Unit 4):** "Which experiment did you run that didn't work? What did it teach you?"

You don't need to know the right answer. You're modeling curiosity, not expertise.

2. Be a customer (if asked)

Your student may ask to interview you or roleplay a sales call. Treat it like a real conversation — give them honest answers, including the parts where you'd say no. The most useful thing you can do is not be a cheerleader. If you have a real objection, voice it. They're learning to handle objections.

If it doesn't feel right, it's fine to say so. They have other options.

3. Share a "tight month" story

If you have ever run anything — a side service, a household project with a budget, a fundraiser — the most useful story you can share is the moment you almost ran out of resources and what you did about it.

4. Show up to the final pitch (if you're available)

In Week 36 your student's team will pitch to a panel of adults. If you're invited and available, go. Your role is not "supportive parent" — it's "honest panelist." Ask the question a real customer or investor would ask.

AN INTERLUDE · GRADE 11

"Which people, and how do you know?"

the program's spine question.

1

Things to watch for

A "great idea" that needs you to spend money

Two responses both work:

- **"What did your forecast say it would cost? What month does it pay back?"**
- **"This sounds like a real-launch version, not a class-Capstone version. We can talk about whether to do that as a family."**

Hustle culture creeping into the sprint

The curriculum names "healthy work hours" as one of the three ethical guardrails. The rubric rewards learning velocity, not sleep deprivation. If your student is overworking the sprint, they're not winning it, they're losing it.

Sales skill turning into manipulation

Your student will get good at the 5-step sales conversation. The skill, in the wrong hands, becomes manipulation. The curriculum's "honest claim" criterion is non-negotiable. Home reinforcement matters: if you hear them practicing a misleading claim, push back.

Team conflict at Week 5

A 4-week team lead and a 6-week sprint will surface conflict. Resist solving it for them. Ask: "What does your charter say to do?" If something feels seriously wrong, mention it to the teacher.

Real money requests

If your student asks for real money for a Capstone, that's a family conversation, not a curriculum requirement. Grade 12 is the better year for real-money launches.

Conversation starters (if you want)

- "Tell me one quote a customer actually said to you this week."
- "Which month is your tight month, and why?"
- "What would you refuse to do, even if it would close the sale?"
- "What's the hardest piece of feedback you got this month?"

Privacy and sensitivity

> **“I don't know either. That's why we test.”**
>
> **- CASH, GRADE 11**

The curriculum:

- Uses **fictional names** for personas, not classmates' real names.
- Asks students to use **initials only** in interview transcripts.
- Avoids **family financial details** entirely.
- Uses **neutral examples** that don't assume specific home situations.
- **Never asks** a student to invest family money.

Pivot windows in Weeks 9, 19, and 29 allow ventures to be changed for any reason — including a flag from a caregiver.

A note about success this year

A "successful" Grade 11 student does not necessarily start a real business. A successful student:

- Led three people for four weeks and can name what worked and what didn't.
- Recorded themselves selling and watched it back without flinching.
- Built a 12-month cash flow forecast and named the tight month with two fixes.
- Ran a 6-week sprint with five named experiments and tracked the metrics.
- Delivered a pitch with a "what we learned" slide that named real failures.
- Wrote a no-go list — three things the venture refuses to do, even if they would work.

If you see those six things on the kitchen table this year, the program worked.

AN INTERLUDE · GRADE 11

"Most adults skip this step. You won't."

the band's working assumption.

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Questions?

Your student's teacher is the first stop. The full Curriculum Book and Lesson Plans are available if you'd like a deeper look.

Thank you for being part of this. The biggest predictor of whether a financial-thinking habit sticks is whether it's also alive at home — even at the level of one curious question a quarter.

— The Cash to Company team

Senior expert upgrade pack — After-pitch script

> **"Which people, and how do you know?"**
>
> - CASH, GRADE 11

If your Grade 11 child just delivered a 5-minute investor-style pitch, three questions to ask that aren't "how was it?" —

Question 1: "What was the hardest panel question? How did you answer?" This surfaces evidence-handling.

Question 2: "What's on your 'what we learned' slide? Did the panel push back on it?" This surfaces learning posture (the program's most important asset).

Question 3: "What's your venture's tightest cash month? What did you say you'd do about it?" This surfaces cash-flow understanding — the year's hardest concept.

You don't need to know what the right answers are. You're modeling the questions investors ask. Your kid can answer them — that's the year's measure.

One thing NOT to ask

Don't ask "are you going to launch this for real?" The Cash to Company year teaches whether to launch as a real question. The Capstone Defense at Grade 12 is the place where that question gets answered. At Grade 11, the answer is "we don't know yet — we're testing." That's the right answer.

ROUND 2 PATCH — Three 30-Second Conversation Starters per Quarter (Grade 11)

Quarter 1 (Local Business Case Study + Growth Backlog) 1. Drive-time: "Whats one local business that grew this past year? Whats one decision they made?" — Follow-up: "How would you know?" 2. At dinner: "Your venture is stalled. Whats your 5-experiment growth backlog?" — Follow-up: "Whats the metric for each?" 3. Watching news: "This company grew fast — what experiment do you think they ran?" — Follow-up: "Whats the alternative?"

Quarter 2 (Cash Flow Forecast) 1. Drive-time: "Whats your ventures cash-tight month? Whats the fix?" — Follow-up: "How confident are you in the fix?" 2. At dinner: "Profit is an opinion. Cash is a fact. Walk me through the difference for your venture." — Follow-up: "Whats your runway?" 3. Watching news: "This company shut down despite being profitable. What likely happened to cash?" — Follow-up: "How would you have caught it earlier?"

Quarter 3 (Sales Conversation + Sprint) 1. Drive-time: "Run me through your 5-step sales conversation. What objection are you stuck on?" — Follow-up: "Whats the honest answer to that objection?" 2. At dinner: "Whats your demo for next weeks sprint check-in?" — Follow-up: "Whats the metric youll show?" 3. Watching ads: "What sales conversation do you think this companys reps run? What questions do they ask?"

Quarter 4 ("Your Kid Just Delivered a 5-Min Investor Pitch — Three Things to Ask" Script)

If your child just gave a 5-minute investor-style pitch, do not ask "how was it?" Instead, ask:

1. "What was the one number you cited that you were least sure about?" — Forces honesty about evidence quality.
2. "What was the toughest panel question, and what did you learn from it?" — Shifts focus from performance to learning.
3. "Whats your next version of the pitch — what changes based on feedback?" — Activates revision mindset.

These three questions skip the praise-or-complain reflex and go straight to the founders growth posture.

> **SENSITIVITY**
>
> None of these require the family to share home finances. They work for any family.

ROUND 2 PATCH — What Cash Never Says (Parent Reference)

Cash will never say: "Amazing!" / "Everyone can be rich" / "Easy money" / "Passive income" / "Just believe in yourself" (as substitute for evidence) / anything implying money problems are a personal failing.

Cash always asks: "Which people, and how do you know?" / "Whats the evidence?"

Why this matters at home. Your child will encounter financial-literacy content from many sources, some hustle-bro coded. The contrast is the point. Cash is on your familys side: clear-eyed, honest, never selling.

One question this year: "What would have to be true for your venture to be wrong? How would you know?"

ENDNOTES & STANDARDS

Citations and alignment

Grade 11 cites 3-6 standards across CCSS, Jump$tart, CEE, CASEL, and C3 frameworks. Detailed alignment lives in the master Standards Alignment Map.

1. **Jump$tart Coalition Personal Finance Standards (2021 ed.).** Spending and Saving; Credit and Debt; Employment and Income; Investing; Risk Management and Insurance; Financial Decision Making.
2. **Council for Economic Education (CEE).** Voluntary National Content Standards in Economics.
3. **CCSS-ELA, Grades 11-12.** W.11-12.1, W.11-12.4, SL.11-12.1, SL.11-12.4, RST.11-12.7.
4. **CCSS-Math.** N-Q.1-3 (Reasoning with Quantities), S-IC (Statistics & Inferences), F-IF (Functions), MP.4 (Modeling).
5. **CASEL Core Competencies.** Self-Awareness, Self-Management, Social Awareness, Relationship Skills, Responsible Decision-Making.
6. **C3 Framework for Social Studies State Standards.** Dimension 2 (Economics, Civics) at the high-school grade band.
7. **NGSS-ETS Engineering Practices.** ETS1 (Engineering Design) for the test-and-iterate spine of the year.
8. **Cash to Company Master Scope & Sequence.** 13 grades x 8 strands x 36 weeks; outcomes quoted verbatim from _master/00_Master_Scope_and_Sequence.md.
9. **Cash Mascot Style Guide.** 9-12 voice rules: multi-sentence arguments; vocabulary includes unit economics, runway, premortem, MVP; never flatters, never promises wealth.
10. **Sensitivity protocol.** No probing of family finances; financial scenarios framed as hypothetical for a sample household, business, or scenario.

One promise.

Cash to Company makes one promise: students who move t
program will be clearer thinkers about money and entrepren
matter what they end up doing for a living.

We do not promise wealth. We do not promise success. We pro

> **"Leading three people, listening to one customer, executing six weeks."**
>
> **- CASH, GRADE 11**

For educational use. This curriculum is informational and does not constitute financial, legal, or tax advice. Standards alignment cited per the Cash to Company Standards Alignment Map (Jump$tart, CEE, CCSS, C3, CASEL, NGSS-ETS).